



FULL-BLEED HERO PHOTOGRAPH
RECOMMENDED: WAITEMATĀ HARBOUR / SKY TOWER

— YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS HERE

Auckland Relocation Guide

WRITTEN BY ETHICARE RESOURCING · TĀMAKI MAKĀURAU



Kia ora, and a warm welcome to Aotearoa.

Kia ora, and a warm welcome to Aotearoa. We're excited to support you as you begin this new chapter in Auckland — New Zealand's largest and most cosmopolitan city.

Moving overseas is a big step, but you won't be doing it alone. There's a whole community here ready to welcome you, both inside and outside of work. New Zealanders are known for their warmth and manaakitanga (hospitality), and Auckland's diversity means you'll find a little of everywhere here.

This guide is designed to make your transition smooth and stress-free — covering everything from housing and transport to the healthcare system, finances, schooling, and where to explore on your days off.



Lifestyle / welcome photograph

RECOMMENDED: AUCKLAND WATERFRONT OR FAMILY

Nau mai, haere mai ki Aotearoa! (Welcome to New Zealand!)

Ngā mihi nui,
The Ethicare Team

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— QUICK FACTS

LOCATION	POPULATION
Largest city, upper North Island	~1.7 million (about a third of NZ)
CLIMATE	MAIN HOSPITALS
Warm, humid subtropical	Auckland City, Middlemore, North Shore
AIRPORT	NEARBY
Auckland (AKL) — NZ's main hub	Waiheke Island, Piha, Hauraki Gulf

The City of Sails

Built on a field of dormant volcanoes between two harbours, Tāmaki Makaurau — 'Tāmaki desired by many' — was prized by Māori for centuries before becoming New Zealand's commercial capital.

1.7M

RESIDENTS — NZ'S LARGEST CITY

200+

ETHNICITIES LIVING SIDE BY SIDE

50+

ISLANDS IN THE HAURAKI GULF

Why many professionals enjoy Auckland

- The largest and most varied healthcare job market in NZ
- World-class dining, arts and a buzzing waterfront
- Island and beach escapes within easy reach
- The most internationally connected city in the country

A Polynesian gateway and modern metropolis

Waves of migration — Māori, European, Pacific and Asian — have made Auckland New Zealand's most multicultural city, reflected in its food, festivals and the energy of its neighbourhoods.

The isthmus has been settled for centuries, its volcanic cones once home to fortified pā. Today the city celebrates its Māori heritage at the Auckland War Memorial Museum and through a vibrant calendar of cultural events.

Pasifika — the world's largest Pacific festival — lights up the city each year, alongside Diwali, Lantern and Matariki celebrations that reflect Auckland's diversity.

“

From the harbour to the islands, Auckland puts a world of lifestyle within 40 minutes of the city centre.

ON LIFE IN AUCKLAND



Cultural moment

RECOMMENDED: AUCKLAND LANDMARK

Getting around

Here is how people get around Auckland day to day – and what to know about driving in New Zealand.

FERRIES

Scenic commuter and island ferries cross the Waitematā to Devonport, Waiheke and beyond.

TRAINS & BUSES

The AT network and new City Rail Link connect the city – use an AT HOP card for easy travel.

DRIVING

Motorways link the region; a car is useful given Auckland's spread-out geography.

AIRPORT

Auckland Airport is NZ's main international gateway, with flights worldwide.

On the road

- New Zealanders drive on the left
- You can usually drive on a valid overseas licence for up to 12 months before converting to a NZ one
- A local transport card makes buses and trains easy
- Keep your overseas licence and any translation handy when you first arrive

A year in the local climate

Auckland has a warm, humid climate — mild winters and warm summers, with rain spread through the year and plenty of sunshine. Frosts are rare.

Summer

DEC – FEB

20–25°

AVG DAYTIME

Autumn

MAR – MAY

17–21°

AVG DAYTIME

Winter

JUN – AUG

11–15°

AVG DAYTIME

Spring

SEP – NOV

15–19°

AVG DAYTIME



Seasonal / scenic photograph

RECOMMENDED: WAIHEKE, PIHA OR SAILING

The coastal setting means summers rarely get uncomfortably hot and winters stay mild. Bring layers and a raincoat — Auckland weather can shift quickly, but the sun is rarely far away.

A well-established health system

Auckland has the most comprehensive healthcare network in New Zealand, with services delivered by Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora across three metropolitan districts.

Auckland City Hospital

One of NZ's largest tertiary hospitals – acute, surgical, specialist and emergency care, plus Starship Children's Hospital.

Middlemore Hospital

A major hospital in South Auckland, known nationally for its trauma, burns and plastic-surgery services.

North Shore Hospital

Serves the rapidly growing North Shore with acute, medical and surgical services.

Waitākere Hospital

Serves West Auckland with medical, maternity and outpatient services.

Public & private

- Public healthcare is funded through general taxation
- ACC provides no-fault accident cover for everyone
- Private hospitals offer elective procedures and shorter waits
- Many residents hold private health insurance alongside the public system

GPs, pharmacies & urgent care

Registering with a GP and dentist

After you settle in, enrol with a local GP (General Practitioner). Enrolment means subsidised visits — typically around NZ\$50–\$70 when enrolled, more if you are a casual patient. Many practices allow online enrolment once you have an address. Dental care is private; expect roughly NZ\$90–\$150 for a check-up.

Pharmacies

Pharmacies are found throughout the region. Prescriptions are partly subsidised once you are enrolled with a GP — commonly a small standard charge per item.

Emergency & after-hours

- **Emergency Departments** — for urgent or critical care; in an emergency, dial 111
- **Urgent care clinics** — accident & medical clinics offer extended-hours care
- **Healthline 0800 611 116** — free 24/7 advice from registered nurses

Setting up your finances

Getting your finances in order early makes day-to-day life much easier. Most of this can be started before you arrive.

Opening a bank account

The major banks are ANZ, ASB, BNZ, Kiwibank and Westpac. You will usually need your passport, work or resident visa, and proof of a NZ address. Many banks let you start online before arrival, then activate in person. Ask for online banking and a debit card at the same time.

Tax (IRD number)

Every worker needs an IRD number from Inland Revenue. Apply online once you have a NZ address and bank account; processing usually takes around 7–10 working days. Give the number to your payroll team as soon as it arrives so the correct tax is applied. Wages are commonly paid fortnightly.

● Tip

Start your bank account application before you fly — having an account number ready makes your IRD application and payroll setup much smoother.

KiwiSaver & sending money home

KiwiSaver is a government-supported retirement savings scheme. On a work visa you can usually opt in or out. Contributions are a percentage of your pay (commonly 3%, 4%, 6%, 8% or 10%), with employers contributing at least 3%. You can withdraw your funds if you permanently leave New Zealand.

Sending money overseas: banks can transfer internationally, but specialist services such as Wise or OFX are often cheaper and faster. Always compare the exchange rate and the fees before moving larger amounts.

SET UP	WHY IT MATTERS	WHEN
Bank account	Receive salary, pay bills locally	Before / on arrival
IRD number	Be taxed correctly	First weeks
KiwiSaver	Retirement savings + employer top-up	When you start work
ACC	No-fault accident cover	Automatic

What life costs in Auckland

Auckland is New Zealand's most expensive city, driven mainly by housing — though wages are typically higher and the job market is the deepest in the country.

\$650/wk

3-BED HOUSE (APPROX. MEDIAN)

\$2.80/L

APPROX. PETROL PRICE

Left

SIDE OF THE ROAD

EVERYDAY ITEM	APPROX. PRICE (NZ\$)
1 litre of milk	\$2.50 – \$3.50
Loaf of bread	\$2.50 – \$4.00
Dozen eggs	\$7 – \$10
Flat white coffee	\$5.50 – \$6.50
Mid-range meal for one	\$25 – \$40
Monthly gym membership	\$60 – \$100
Home broadband	\$75 – \$100 / month

Prices are indicative and change over time — use the calculators at the back of this guide for a personalised estimate.

An example monthly budget

A rough single-person monthly budget for a Auckland renter. Yours will vary with lifestyle, household size and suburb.

CATEGORY	APPROX. MONTHLY (NZ\$)
Rent (room / small 1-bed)	\$1,600 – \$2,400
Power & water	\$150 – \$220
Internet	\$75 – \$100
Public transport (AT HOP)	\$140 – \$200
Groceries	\$450 – \$650
Mobile phone plan	\$30 – \$50
Entertainment & leisure	\$200 – \$400
Estimated total	\$2,650 – \$4,000

Make it personal

- Use Numbeo to compare Auckland with your current city
- Map your own incomings and outgoings with the Sorted budget planner (sorted.org.nz)

A note from Sophie

A personal word from our Founder on what makes Auckland special — and who it tends to suit.



● SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

Auckland is where most journeys into New Zealand begin — it's the biggest, most connected city, with the deepest healthcare job market in the country.

It rewards people who want big-city life with the outdoors close by. Housing is the main cost to plan for, but few places offer this much variety within forty minutes of home.

Sophie Careem · Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing

● From the Ethicare team

Your Ethicare contact is here to help with every step of your move to Auckland — from accommodation to payroll setup. Reach out any time.

Finding a place to live

Auckland offers everything from inner-city apartments to suburban family homes and beachside properties. Where you live shapes your commute, so think about transport links to work.



Housing / suburb photograph

RECOMMENDED: SUBURBAN STREET OR APARTMENTS

Useful property websites

- trademe.co.nz/property – NZ's largest rental marketplace
- realestate.co.nz – nationwide rentals and homes for sale

A guide to the areas

An orientation to the main areas of Auckland — each with its own character, price point and who it tends to suit.

City Centre, Viaduct & Wynyard

Apartments, waterfront dining and nightlife, walkable to the CBD — ideal if you don't want a car.

Ponsonby, Grey Lynn & Herne Bay

Leafy villas, cafés and boutiques close to town; characterful and sought-after, with prices to match.

Mt Eden, Mt Albert & Sandringham

Central, well-connected family suburbs with a rich multicultural food scene.

Newmarket & Parnell

Upmarket inner suburbs with premium shopping, heritage streets and easy CBD access.

Across the wider region

North Shore (Takapuna, Devonport, Albany)

Beaches, family suburbs and good schools, linked to the city by motorway and the Northern Busway.

West Auckland (Henderson, Te Atatū, Titirangi)

More affordable, close to the Waitākere Ranges and west-coast surf beaches; a relaxed, green lifestyle.

Central East (Ellerslie, Mt Wellington, Glen Innes)

Handy, mixed and generally better value, with Sylvia Park and rail links close by.

South & East (Manukau, Howick, Botany)

Diverse, well-connected and among the city's best value, with Middlemore Hospital nearby.

A tip on choosing

- Think about your commute to work and school zones if you have children
- Where you live can decide which state school your children attend – check the zone before you sign
- Many people rent for a few months first to get to know the areas

Utilities, rates & rubbish

POWER & GAS

Choose from providers like Genesis, Mercury, Meridian and Contact. Compare rates on Powerswitch (powerswitch.org.nz).

WATER & RATES

Council rates fund local services; if you rent, rates are usually included in your rent.

RUBBISH & RECYCLING

Kerbside collection is run by the local council, with separate bins for rubbish, recycling and food scraps.

INTERNET

Most homes have fibre broadband; Spark, One NZ and 2degrees are the main providers.

Set-up quick links

Compare power

powerswitch.org.nz

Post & parcels

nzpost.co.nz

Tenancy advice

tenancy.govt.nz

Where to shop

Auckland offers malls, town centres and weekend markets. A few of the main ones:

Sylvia Park (Mt Wellington)

New Zealand's largest mall – 200+ stores, dining and a cinema, with its own train station.

Westfield Newmarket

The premium fashion-led mall, with David Jones and an IMAX cinema, near Newmarket station.

Commercial Bay (CBD)

Harbour-edge dining and retail in the city centre, integrated with Britomart station.

Botany & Manukau

Open-air Botany Town Centre and Westfield Manukau serve the fast-growing south and east.

Supermarkets & groceries

New Zealand's supermarkets fall into a few main groups. Knowing the difference helps you balance budget and convenience.

Pak'nSave

The cheapest of the big chains — a no-frills, bulk-buy warehouse format. Best for budget shopping.

Woolworths

Mid-range and widespread, with strong online shopping and delivery (formerly Countdown).

New World

More upmarket, with a wider fresh and specialty range.

Four Square & FreshChoice

Smaller neighbourhood stores for convenience and top-ups.

Auckland has Pak'nSave, Woolworths and New World across the city, plus Costco at Westgate for bulk shopping. Bring your own bags — single-use plastic bags are banned.

Specialty & international food

One of the joys of settling into Auckland is finding the flavours of home — or exploring new ones.

Halal & South Asian

Halal butchers and groceries are easy to find around Sandringham, Mt Roskill and Papatoetoe; many supermarket lines are halal-processed — check the label.

Asian (Chinese, Korean, Japanese, SE Asian)

Dominion Road, Northcote and Botany have a deep range of Asian supermarkets, produce and restaurants.

Pacific, British & European

Ōtara Market is the place for Pacific produce; specialty importers and 'Saffa' and British shops stock familiar brands.

Smaller independent stores open and close over time — a quick search for "halal butcher near me" or your home cuisine will surface the current options near your suburb.

Places of worship

Auckland reflects New Zealand's spiritual diversity, with welcoming communities across many faiths.

Auckland has Christian churches of many denominations, several mosques, Hindu mandirs and Sikh gurdwaras, Buddhist temples including Fo Guang Shan, and an established Jewish community.

Finding your community

- Most faith communities list service times and locations online
- Many warmly welcome newcomers and visitors
- They can be one of the quickest ways to build a support network when you arrive

A world of lifestyle on your doorstep

Few cities pack in this much variety – surf beaches, native bush, island wineries and a harbour built for sailing, all within easy reach of downtown.



Recreation hero photograph

RECOMMENDED: WAIHEKE, PIHA OR SAILING

Don't-miss experiences

- Ferry to Waiheke Island for vineyards and beaches
- Surf the wild west-coast beaches at Piha and Muriwai
- Climb or leap from the Sky Tower for 360° views
- Explore Māori and Pacific treasures at Auckland Museum

Ten things not to miss

A starter list to get to know Auckland and the wider region.

- 1 Ferry to Waiheke Island**
Vineyards, beaches and restaurants, a 40-minute ferry from downtown.
- 2 Surf at Piha**
Wild black-sand west-coast beach beneath Lion Rock.
- 3 Sky Tower**
360° views — or a SkyJump for the brave.
- 4 Auckland Museum & Domain**
Māori and Pacific treasures in a grand parkland setting.
- 5 Climb Maungawhau / Mt Eden**
The city's most accessible volcanic summit.
- 6 Tāwharanui or Wenderholm**
Regional parks with white-sand beaches north of the city.
- 7 Wynyard Quarter & Viaduct**
Waterfront dining and the marine precinct.
- 8 Rangitoto Island**
Hike the iconic volcanic cone in the Hauraki Gulf.
- 9 Karangahape Road (K' Rd)**
Auckland's most eclectic strip for food, bars and music.
- 10 Cornwall Park & One Tree Hill**
Sheep-dotted parkland and a hilltop monument.

Travel from Auckland

Auckland is a great base for exploring. Some favourite weekend escapes:

Bay of Islands (~3 hrs)

Subtropical beaches, island cruises and the Waitangi Treaty Grounds.

Coromandel (~2 hrs)

Cathedral Cove and Hot Water Beach, where you dig your own hot pool.

Waikato & Hobbiton (~1.5–2 hrs)

The Hobbiton movie set and the Waitomo glow-worm caves.

Rotorua (~3 hrs)

Geysers, hot springs, mud pools and Māori cultural experiences.

Flying onward

- Domestic flights reach the main centres in around 1–2 hours
- Book early for the best fares on Air New Zealand and Jetstar
- Many regions are also linked by scenic road and rail journeys

Schooling & study

Auckland offers a full range of early childhood education, schools and tertiary study.

Early Childhood Education (ECE)

Kindergartens, daycare, Montessori, kōhanga reo and home-based care for ages 0–5. Government 20-hours funding applies for ages 3–5.

Primary & intermediate

State, state-integrated and private schools for Years 1–8.

Secondary

Years 9–13, working towards NCEA, the national qualification.

Tertiary

Universities and institutes of technology across the country.

School terms run late January to mid-December, in four terms with two-week breaks in April, July and October.

School zones come first

In New Zealand, where you live usually determines which state school your children can attend. For many families, the school decision leads the choice of where to rent or buy.

In-zone = guaranteed

Children living inside a school's enrolment zone are guaranteed a place at that school.

Out-of-zone = ballot

If you live outside the zone you can still apply, but places aren't guaranteed – popular schools run a ballot for limited spots.

Zones are street-by-street

Boundaries can run down the middle of a street, so check the exact address.

● **The order that works best**

1) Shortlist schools you like → 2) Check each school's zone map → 3) Search for rentals inside that zone → 4) Confirm the address is in-zone before you sign.

Childcare for working families

Early childhood (0–5). Daycare, kindergartens, Montessori and home-based care are widely available. The government's 20 Hours ECE funding subsidises care for ages 3–5 at participating centres.

Before & after school (OSCAR). Many schools and providers run breakfast clubs, after-school care and holiday programmes. Subsidies may be available through Work and Income for eligible families.

TYPE OF CARE	APPROX. COST (NZ\$)
Full-time daycare (under 3)	\$350 – \$450 / week before subsidies
20 Hours ECE (ages 3–5)	Up to 20 hrs/week subsidised; extra hours charged
After-school care (OSCAR)	\$5 – \$15 per afternoon, varies by provider
School holiday programme	\$40 – \$60 per day, activity-based

Costs are indicative and vary by provider and suburb. If you'll work shifts, ask providers about flexible hours.

Auckland for families

Beyond school and work, Auckland is an easy, outdoorsy place to raise a family.

FREE & OUTDOORS

Regional parks, beaches, playgrounds and the Auckland Domain — much of the best family fun is free.

RAINY-DAY OPTIONS

MOTAT, the Maritime Museum, Auckland Zoo and Kelly Tarlton's keep kids busy.

LIBRARIES & PLUNKET

Free local libraries run children's programmes; Plunket supports families with young children.

GETTING AROUND

Under-5s travel free on public transport, and many malls have play areas and parents' rooms.

Settling kids in

- Children often settle fastest through school, sport and weekend activities
- Local clubs — football, netball, rugby, swimming — are inexpensive and welcoming
- They're a great way for the whole family to meet people

Pre-departure checklist

Work through these before you fly. Keep digital and printed copies of everything important.

Documents

- ☐ Passport + valid NZ visa (printed too)
- ☐ Job offer & employment contract
- ☐ Qualifications & certificates
- ☐ References & employment history

Money & travel

- ☐ Apply online for a NZ bank account
- ☐ Documents ready for your IRD number
- ☐ Confirm airline baggage allowance
- ☐ Book temporary accommodation

Your first weeks

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Move into your accommodation | ☐ Open / activate your bank account |
| ☐ Apply for your IRD number | ☐ Get a NZ SIM card |
| ☐ Register with a local GP | ☐ Set up power, water and internet |
| ☐ Learn your transport routes to work | ☐ Save 111 and Healthline in your phone |
| ☐ Find your nearest pharmacy & supermarket | ☐ Explore your local neighbourhood |

● You're not alone

Your Ethicare contact is here to help with any of these steps – from accommodation to payroll setup. Reach out any time.

Key numbers & contacts

In any emergency – police, fire or ambulance – dial **111**.

Emergency & health

Emergency	111
Healthline	0800 611 116
Mental health	Call/text 1737
Police (non-urgent)	105

Everyday services

Tax (IRD)	ird.govt.nz
Immigration	immigration.govt.nz
AA roadside	0800 500 222
Local council	govt.nz/organisations

Banks

ANZ	anz.co.nz
ASB	asb.co.nz
BNZ	bnz.co.nz
Kiwibank	kiwibank.co.nz
Westpac	westpac.co.nz

Community & expat groups

One of the quickest ways to settle in is to find your people. Auckland has active communities for almost every interest and background.

Facebook groups

Search for groups like "Expats in Auckland", your home-country community, and local suburb buy/sell and parents' groups.

Meetup & interest groups

Meetup.com lists hiking, sport, hobby and newcomer groups — a relaxed way to meet people.

Sports & cultural clubs

Local football, netball, rugby and cricket clubs, plus cultural and faith communities, all welcome newcomers.

Workplace networks

Many hospitals and employers have social clubs and buddy systems for new and international staff.

Rainbow / LGBTQ+ community

- New Zealand is welcoming and progressive — marriage equality has been law since 2013
- There are strong legal protections against discrimination
- OutLine Aotearoa offers rainbow mental-health support (0800 688 5463)

Everyday Māori & Kiwi phrases

Te reo Māori is part of everyday life, and Kiwis have their own slang too.

Te reo Māori

Kia ora Hello / thanks

Nau mai, haere mai Welcome

Whānau Family

Hauora Health & wellbeing

Manaakitanga Hospitality, kindness

Mōrena Good morning

Ka kite anō See you later

Tamariki Children

Ngā mihi nui Many thanks

Aotearoa New Zealand

Kiwi slang

Sweet as Great / no worries

Keen Up for it

Dairy Corner shop

Jandals Flip-flops

Flatting Shared renting

Chur Cheers / thanks

Heaps Lots

Togs Swimwear

Shout Your turn to pay

Knackered Tired

Work out your cost of living.

Use these tools to estimate what life in Auckland would really cost for you and your family.

Cost-of-living calculators

Compare cities (Numbeo)	numbeo.com/cost-of-living
Budget planner (Sorted)	sorted.org.nz/tools/budget-planner
Living-costs data (Stats NZ)	stats.govt.nz
Take-home pay (IRD)	ird.govt.nz

We hope you've found this guide useful. Moving to the other side of the world is a big step, and there's a lot to take in – so please don't feel you have to have it all figured out at once.

Whatever stage you're at, we're always happy to talk anything through – the big decisions or the small worries. Just reach out to your Ethicare contact whenever you need us.

Ngā mihi nui

The Ethicare team



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